

General Montgomery, at El Alamein, that Rommel's advance was checked. The next month, the "Torch Landings" in Morocco and Algeria brought Allied reinforcements with US tanks and fresh troops. Within six months, after fierce fighting in Tunisia, the Axis powers (see p.393) were defeated in Africa.

The Axis surrender in North Africa was followed by the successful Allied invasion of Sicily, after which Hitler's key ally, Italy, secretly surrendered. In 1944, while the Red Army drove Axis forces out of the Soviet Union, Allied troops invaded Normandy, France (see pp.398–99). After the liberation of France, Germany made one last stand at the Battle of the Bulge in the Ardennes, Belgium, where more than 80,000 US troops and a similar number of

Germans were lost. Once Belgium and the Netherlands were liberated, the Allies entered Germany from the west and Russia invaded from the east. The Red Army's arrival in Berlin in April 1945 was followed by Hitler's suicide and unconditional German surrender. Victory in Europe was declared on May 8, 1945.

The Road to Berlin

By 1943, after Germany's defeat at Stalingrad (see p.394) and victories for British and US forces in Africa, the Allies held the advantage. British and US forces landed in Italy, while Soviet troops swept across Eastern Europe. With the D-Day landings (see p.399) in 1944, and Allied bombings, the Nazis faced attack on all fronts.

KEY

- Greater German Reich, 1942
- Allied offensives
- city severely bombed
- ✕ major battle
- partisan resistance
- frontiers 1942



Relief at the end of war in Europe was tempered by grief at the immense loss of life and a resolve to achieve world peace.

ENDING THE WAR

After the Red Army took Berlin, the end of the war in Europe (VE Day) was officially declared on May 8, 1945. Huge celebrations took place, particularly in London. **War with Japan** continued until VJ Day on August 15 **402–03** >>.



SOVIET TROOPS RAISE THE FLAG IN BERLIN

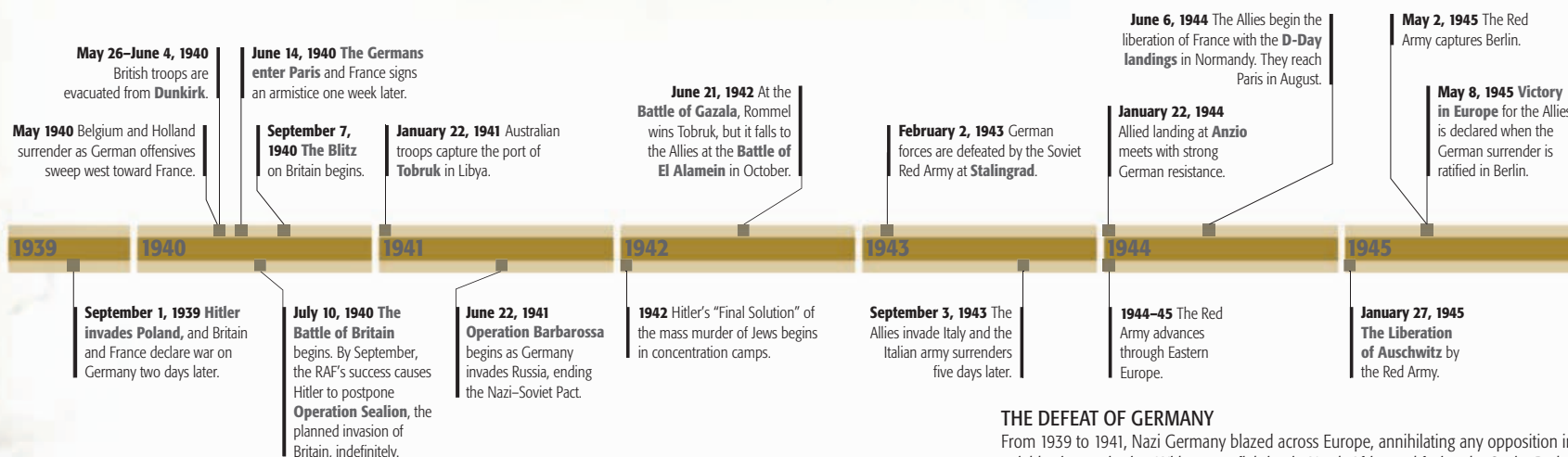
COSTS OF WAR

The costs of World War II were immense. In terms of loss of human life, the statistics are appalling. The financial costs have been estimated at over \$2 billion.

DEAD 25 million Russians, 6 million Poles, 5 million Germans, 400 thousand French, 300 thousand Britons—almost 60 million died worldwide.

YALTA AND POTSDAM CONFERENCES

In 1945 leaders from Britain, the Soviet Union, and the US met at conferences at Yalta (in Ukraine) and Potsdam (Germany) to deal with the **political and economic issues** raised by the war. Among the measures decided on were the creation of a new world peacekeeping organization, **the United Nations**, and the division of Germany into four zones of control, each administered by an Allied power.



THE DEFEAT OF GERMANY

From 1939 to 1941, Nazi Germany blazed across Europe, annihilating any opposition in neighboring territories. With troops fighting in North Africa and facing the Soviet Red Army outside Moscow, German forces had conquered vast territories by the winter of 1941. Yet in April 1945 the Allies were swiftly advancing on the German capital, Berlin.